

## 4.5 Building blocks for understanding

The periodic table has many patterns and relationships, and is used by chemists to observe patterns and relationships between the elements. These patterns help to predict properties. For example, elements to the bottom and far left of the table are the most metallic and elements on the top right are the least metallic.

It is also possible to analyse substances to find out how these elements have combined to form compounds and from this to deduce chemical equations. Chemists have a common language for talking about reactions that is understood across the world. This means that they can share their knowledge about chemical reactions and solutions to problems such as ways to improve product yield.